

# Connecticut Craft Beer Market Landscape

Executive market profile of Connecticut craft beer using supplied public-web evidence from the last 24-month discovery run

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|------------------|-----------------|----------------------------|--------------|
| GEOGRAPHY        | INDUSTRY        | SOURCES                    | DATE         |
| Connecticut, USA | market research | 146 (115 high credibility) | June 3, 2026 |

SOURCE

Tavily Open Web Discovery

## KEY FINDINGS

- Connecticut craft beer has documented historical economic significance, including \$718 million in statewide economic impact in 2016 and \$373.6 million in economic activity in 2012 (src-023; src-001).
- The broader U.S. craft category is mature and volume-pressured, with production declines reported in both 2024 and 2025 (src-003; src-009).
- Craft beer's value position has been more resilient than volume, with meaningful retail dollar share maintained in the national evidence (src-003; src-009).
- Connecticut competitive evidence highlights named operators such as Two Roads Brewing Company, Black Hog Brewery, and Charter Oak Brewing Co., but does not provide market-share rankings (src-017; src-023).
- Consumer demand, favorable laws, customer experience, and operational infrastructure appear as recurring themes in the Connecticut evidence (src-001; src-023).
- Non-alcoholic beer is a relevant adjacent growth theme, but the supplied evidence is global and should not be treated as Connecticut-specific demand measurement (src-002).

## Executive Summary

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Connecticut's craft beer industry is best read as a locally rooted market operating inside a maturing national craft category. The supplied Connecticut-specific evidence shows a sector that had already become economically meaningful before the current period, with reported statewide craft brewery economic impact of \$718 million in 2016 and earlier evidence of \$373.6 million in economic activity in 2012, when the state had fewer breweries (src-023; src-001).

The national context is less expansionary than the earlier craft growth cycle. Brewers Association evidence indicates U.S. craft production fell in 2024, while retail dollar value still rose, and a subsequent 2025 update described another production decline alongside essentially stable retail dollar share (src-003; src-009). For Connecticut operators, that points to a market where brand quality, taproom economics, distribution discipline, and local engagement matter more than simple category growth.

The evidence package identifies Connecticut players and operating models rather than a complete state-by-state revenue table. Two Roads Brewing Company appears as a concrete Connecticut example through Beer Institute profile evidence, while Black Hog Brewery and Charter Oak Brewing Co. appear in evidence focused on brewery operations and customer experience infrastructure (src-017; src-023).

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## Market Overview

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The Connecticut market has evidence of meaningful local scale, but the discovery run does not provide a current, source-level Connecticut revenue figure. The strongest state-specific quantitative anchors are historical: \$373.6 million in economic activity in 2012 and \$718 million in statewide economic impact in 2016 (src-001; src-023). These figures establish that craft beer had moved beyond a niche presence in the state, though they should not be treated as current market size estimates.

National craft beer data supplied in the request shows the broader market entering a more mature phase. In 2024, U.S. craft brewers produced 23.1 million barrels, down 3.9% from the prior year, while craft retail dollar value rose to an estimated \$28.8 billion and represented 24.7% of total beer retail dollar sales (src-003). The 2025 evidence then shows total craft production falling 5% to 21,859,000 barrels, with craft maintaining a 24.6% share of total beer retail dollar sales (src-009).

For Connecticut, the implication supported by the evidence is not that local demand is collapsing, but that the market is likely operating under national category pressure. The supplied sources describe consumer demand, favorable state laws, local business technology needs, and brewery-level differentiation as important market factors, while the national data shows volume headwinds and a relatively resilient value position (src-001; src-003; src-009; src-023).

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## Competitive Landscape

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The supplied evidence supports a competitive landscape built around independent breweries, local identity, and operational execution. Two Roads Brewing Company is specifically represented through a Connecticut-based Beer Institute profile, including a regional sales director role tied to the company's home market and experience across the three tiers of the craft beer industry (src-017).

Black Hog Brewery and Charter Oak Brewing Co. appear as examples of Connecticut craft breweries investing in business technology to improve customer experience and streamline operations (src-023). That evidence is operational rather than market-share based, but it is

useful because it shows competition extending beyond beer styles into taproom service, connectivity, marketing reach, and back-office reliability.

Nationally, craft beer faces a more concentrated beer market and ongoing pressure from larger producers. Alcohol.org's supplied summary notes that large U.S. brewers continue to dominate industry sales even as small, independent craft breweries have become more prominent, while Brewers Association data shows craft retaining substantial retail dollar share despite volume declines (src-008; src-003; src-009).

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## Pricing & Distribution

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The evidence package does not provide a reliable source-level Connecticut retail price benchmark for craft beer. It does, however, provide national evidence that craft's value position has held up better than volume: 2024 retail dollar value rose even as production declined, and 2025 evidence shows craft maintaining a 24.6% retail dollar share while production fell again (src-003; src-009).

Distribution evidence is strongest at the business-model level rather than through Connecticut channel volumes. The Beer Institute profile for Two Roads references experience across the three tiers of the craft beer industry, which is relevant to the producer-distributor-retailer structure that shapes beer go-to-market execution (src-017). National beer market evidence also identifies distribution channels as part of the broader U.S. beer market analysis, but the supplied excerpt does not isolate Connecticut-specific channel shares (src-005).

For Connecticut breweries, onsite sales and local customer experience appear material in the evidence. Brewers Association commentary says onsite sales outpaced distributed sales in many markets in 2024, while Connecticut brewery examples emphasize technology and customer experience improvements at operating sites (src-003; src-023).

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## Regulatory Environment

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The request evidence indicates that law and regulation have mattered to Connecticut craft beer development, but the supplied sources do not provide a detailed current statutory map. Hartford Business evidence states that consumer demand and favorable state laws helped spur a surge of craft brewery startups in Connecticut (src-001).

The broader literature in the evidence package supports the idea that legislation can shape craft beer development. The MDPI source is explicitly focused on the impact of legislation on craft beer development and frames regulation as a relevant market condition, though the excerpt supplied is not Connecticut-specific (src-006).

Because the discovery package lacks current primary regulatory detail for Connecticut, regulatory conclusions should remain narrow. The defensible finding is that legal conditions have been identified as a historical enabler in Connecticut and as a structural factor in craft beer development more broadly; it would not be evidence-grounded to infer specific current licensing, tax, or self-distribution rules from the supplied source excerpts alone (src-001; src-006).

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## Consumer Trends

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Consumer demand for craft and premium beer is a recurring signal in the evidence package. Hartford Business identifies consumer demand as one of the forces behind Connecticut craft brewery startup growth, while a U.S. beer market source describes growing demand for craft and premium beers as a growth driver nationally (src-001; src-005).

At the national category level, craft beer's retail-dollar resilience suggests consumers continue to assign value to craft offerings even as volumes soften. Brewers Association evidence shows craft retail dollar value rising in 2024 despite lower production, followed by 2025 data in which craft maintained a 24.6% retail dollar share despite a production decline (src-003; src-009).

Non-alcoholic beer is a relevant adjacent trend, though the supplied source is global rather than Connecticut-specific. Global Market Insights reports the global non-alcoholic beer market at USD 24 billion in 2025, with forecast growth from USD 25.9 billion in 2026 to USD 50.8 billion in 2035 at a 7.8% CAGR; this supports monitoring non-alcoholic beer as a consumer trend, not claiming a measured Connecticut adoption rate (src-002).

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## Key Opportunities

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Connecticut breweries have an opportunity to compete on local experience and operating quality. The evidence on Black Hog Brewery and Charter Oak Brewing Co. shows investments in customer experience and streamlined business operations through business technology, which points to a practical opportunity area for taprooms and small brewery operators (src-023).

A second opportunity is value-led resilience rather than volume-led growth. National craft data indicates retail dollar share has remained meaningful even as production declined, suggesting room for operators that can protect pricing, deepen direct customer relationships, and maintain differentiated products (src-003; src-009).

A third opportunity is selective participation in non-alcoholic and lower-alcohol occasions. The supplied non-alcoholic beer market source is global, but its growth outlook is substantial enough to be relevant as a watch area for Connecticut craft producers assessing portfolio extensions, provided local demand is validated separately (src-002).

## Risks & Challenges

The central market risk is category softness. Brewers Association data shows U.S. craft production fell 3.9% in 2024 and then declined another 5% in 2025, with 60% of breweries reporting production declines in the 2025 evidence (src-003; src-009). Connecticut operators are not shown to be exempt from these national headwinds in the supplied evidence.

Competitive pressure remains material. Large U.S. beer producers continue to dominate industry sales according to the supplied Alcohol.org summary, while craft breweries must compete through independence, local engagement, product quality, and consumer experience rather than scale advantages (src-008; src-023).

A further challenge is evidence opacity for current Connecticut-specific sizing, pricing, and channel structure. The discovery run provides useful historical Connecticut impact figures and named local examples, but it does not provide current Connecticut production, sales, pricing, or distribution data in the excerpts available for this editorial draft (src-001; src-014; src-023).

## Sources (146 total)

| Title                                                                                | Domain                 | Type     | Credibility | Score |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------|-------------|-------|
| <a href="#">Hooray Beer! CT craft brewers realize national trend</a>                 | hartfordbusiness.com   | company  | high        | 100   |
| <a href="#">Non-Alcoholic Beer Market Size, Forecasts Report 2026-2035</a>           | gminsights.com         | company  | high        | 100   |
| <a href="#">Brewers Association Reports 2024 U.S. Craft Brewing Industry Figures</a> | brewersassociation.org | industry | high        | 100   |
| <a href="#">The State of Craft Beer   C+R</a>                                        | crresearch.com         | company  | high        | 100   |
| <a href="#">United States Beer Market Insights and Forecast 2025</a>                 | renub.com              | company  | high        | 100   |

| Title                                                                                                                                                                                            | Domain                 | Type          | Credibility | Score |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------|-------------|-------|
| Exploring the Impact of Legislation on the Development of Craft Beer                                                                                                                             | mdpi.com               | company       | high        | 100   |
| April   2026   TheBeerProfessor                                                                                                                                                                  | thebeerprofessor.com   | company       | high        | 100   |
| The Rise of Craft Beer in America   Alcohol.org                                                                                                                                                  | alcohol.org            | company       | high        | 100   |
| A Year of Correction for Craft Beer, With Early Signals of Recovery - Brewers Association                                                                                                        | brewersassociation.org | industry      | high        | 100   |
| United States Beer Market Report 2025-2033 Featuring Asahi, Molson Coors, Tetra Laval, Kirin, Beijing Yanjing Beer, Diageo, Dogfish Head Craft Brewery, Sierra Nevada, Modelo Oettinger Brauerei | finance.yahoo.com      | company       | high        | 100   |
| A Glass Half Full Revisited: When Demographic Momentum Stalls   TheBeerProfessor                                                                                                                 | thebeerprofessor.com   | company       | high        | 100   |
| Craft Beer Market Size, Share and Growth Analysis Report - Forecast Trends and Outlook (2025-2034)                                                                                               | marketresearch.com     | research_firm | high        | 100   |
| Creativity, Community, and Growth: A Social Geography of Urban Craft Beer                                                                                                                        | openjournals.wu.ac.at  | academic      | high        | 100   |
| State Craft Beer Sales & Production Statistics, 2024 - Brewers Association                                                                                                                       | brewersassociation.org | industry      | high        | 100   |
| Industry Fast Facts - NBWA: America's Beer and Beverage Distributors                                                                                                                             | nbwa.org               | company       | high        | 100   |
| Market Research Jobs, Employment in Connecticut - Indeed                                                                                                                                         | indeed.com             | company       | medium      | 69    |
| How can small businesses compete with big-box stores on beer pricing?   Community   BeerAdvocate                                                                                                 | beeradvocate.com       | company       | medium      | 67    |
| Connecticut MarketBeats   US   Cushman & Wakefield                                                                                                                                               | cushmanwakefield.com   | company       | medium      | 60    |
| The following questions are based on the below CASE STUDY                                                                                                                                        | cliffsnotes.com        | company       | medium      | 59    |
| Market Research Analyst jobs in Connecticut - Indeed                                                                                                                                             | indeed.com             | company       | medium      | 59    |

| Title                                                                                                                      | Domain                 | Type    | Credibility | Score |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------|-------------|-------|
| Full-Service Market Research & Consumer Insights Company                                                                   | touchstoneresearch.com | company | medium      | 59    |
| [PDF] 2025 Survey of Connecticut Businesses   CBIA                                                                         | cbia.com               | company | medium      | 58    |
| Top Market Research Companies in Hartford - May 2026 Rankings                                                              | clutch.co              | company | medium      | 57    |
| Podcasts   Craft Beer & Brewing                                                                                            | beerandbrewing.com     | company | medium      | 56    |
| Brewers Association 2024 U.S. Craft Brewing Industry Figures and Top 50 Craft Brewing Companies   Community   BeerAdvocate | beeradvocate.com       | company | medium      | 55    |

**Research limitations:**

- The supplied evidence package does not include a current Connecticut craft beer market size, revenue, production volume, or brewery-count table with extractable source-level values.
- Several quantitative signals are national or global rather than Connecticut-specific, so they are used only as context for local market interpretation.
- The discovery run includes historical Connecticut economic-impact figures from 2012 and 2016, but no comparable current-period Connecticut impact estimate.
- Pricing evidence for Connecticut is insufficient at the cited-source level; the report therefore avoids asserting a current Connecticut craft beer price benchmark.
- Regulatory evidence is directionally relevant but not detailed enough to summarize current Connecticut licensing, tax, self-distribution, or minimum-pricing rules.
- Some discovered sources appear to be broad, dated, duplicative, or only partially extracted; conclusions are limited to claims supported by the supplied source excerpts.